INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# HANDLE, EXTENSION, ALUMINUM, TELESCOPIC, INSULATED HANDLE SHAFT (AND ACCESSORIES)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It has not been coordinated with government agencies and is subject to modification. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers an aluminum telescopic extension handle with insulated handle shaft, adaptors and duster head, to be used where electrical contact presents no problem.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Extension handles.

1.2.1.1 Type and class. Extension handles covered by this specification shall be of one type and class.

1.2.1.2 Size. Size shall be as specified in the contract or order (3.3 and 6.2).

1.2.2 Adaptors. Adaptors covered by this specification shall be of the following styles, as specified (6.2):

Squeegee adaptor
Duster head adaptor
Swivel adaptor

1.2.3 Duster head. Duster head covered by this specification shall be of one type and grade (6.2).

## 2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing.
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601 - Rubber: Sampling and Testing.



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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (6.2), before production is commenced, a preproduction sample of the extension handle and accessories, as applicable, shall be submitted to the contracting officer for approval.

3.2 Design and construction. The telescopic extension handle shall be made of anodized aluminum, with a handle shaft into which one or more tubular extension sections (slider tubes) shall be telescoped. The handle shaft shall be completely insulated as specified in 3.2.2. The outer (distal) end of the innermost slider tube shall have a heavy-duty metal 3/4 - 5 threads per inch Acme thread for a minimum of 1-1/16 inch for direct attachment of brushes, paint rollers and similar items having a threaded hole or socket to fit and for direct attachment of adaptors.

3.2.1 The handle shall be a 2 piece (handle shaft + 1 slider tube), 3 piece (handle shaft + 2 slider tubes) or 4 piece (handle shaft + 3 slider tubes) assembly. The handle shall have a tension tight or other locking arrangement to securely lock the slider tubes in extended positions at any point within the range of adjustment governed by the size specified (3.3). The inner slider tubes shall be smoothly finished. The handle shall be relatively balanced to eliminate "skipping" or abnormal "side thrust" when in an extended position.

3.2.2 Plastic sleeve. The aluminum handle shaft shall be covered with a plastic sleeve made from a virgin vinyl polymer of 90 hardness when tested with a type A Shore durometer as specified in 4.5.1. The wall thickness of the plastic shall be not less than 0.031 inch, and shall be shrunk tightly onto the aluminum tubing. The sleeve shall be unaffected when subjected to a high-low temperature test as specified in 4.5.2. The sleeve shall withstand a voltage of not less than 6,000 RMS, 60 c/s when tested as specified in 4.5.3. The area at the distal end of the handle shaft (e.g. threaded portion) need not be insulated if used in connection with the locking arrangement required in 3.2.1; this area shall not exceed 3/4 inch, however, when measured in the length direction from the distal end of the shaft. The finished handle shall have a molded vinyl cap of the same material and color as the sleeve, securely and permanently attached to the hand end of the handle shaft forming a closed end, or a rubber of vinyl plastic handle grip or closure securely and permanently attached to the hand end of the handle forming a closure.

3.3 Size and dimensions. Size shall be as specified in the contract or order (6.2). The size designation shall be given using two figures; for example "5-10 feet". The size designation shall govern the length of the handle shaft; the maximum extension capability of the handle without attachment of adaptors, brushes, squeegees, etc.; and the intermediate adjustment range. For example, the "5-10 feet" size designation requires a handle shaft of 5 feet, a maximum



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extension capability of 10 feet and be capable of adjustment of length to any point between 5 and 10 feet (3.2.1). Other dimensions shall be as follows:

| | Outside diameter (minimum)(inches) | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Handle shaft | 1st slider tube | 2nd slider tube | Innermost or end slider tube |
| 2 piece handle - | 1 | | | 7/8 |
| 3 piece handle - | 1-1/8 | 1 | | 7/8 |
| 4 piece handle - | 1-1/4 | 1-1/8 | 1 | 7/8 |

Wall thickness (minimum)(inches): handle shaft * - .053
slider tubes - .043

* Measurement includes corrugations if on handle shaft.

Weight: The 5-10 ft. handle shall weigh approximately 1-1/2 lbs. complete. This weight shall be used as a guide to ensure that handles in other size designations are relatively proportionate and conform to reasonable weight limits.

3.4 Accessories.

3.4.1 Adaptors.

3.4.1.1 Squeegee adaptor. The squeegee adaptor shall be made of wood and shall measure 4-1/8 to 4-1/2 inches long overall. One end shall have a threaded hole of the standard Acme size to fit the threaded end of the innermost slider tube as specified in 3.2. The squeegee adaptor shall have a metal ferrule at the threaded end for reinforcement. The dimensions of the fitted ferrule shall be not less than 1-1/16 inches outside diameter and 5/16 inch width and shall overlap the end by not less than 3/32 inch. The outside diameter of the wood immediately adjacent to the ferrule shall be 1-1/8 (+1/16) inches for a distance or not less than 11/16 inch and reduced sharply to a 1 inch diameter. The squeegee adaptor shall be tapered for not less than 3 inches from the 1 inch diameter to a 3/4 inch diameter at the distal end.

3.4.1.2 Duster head adaptor. The duster head adaptor shall have a main body of aluminum tubing, 1 inch outside diameter, approximately 4-1/2 inches long and a wall thickness of not less than .043. One end shall have a wood threaded hole of the standard Acme size to fit the threaded end of the innermost slider tube as specified in 3.2. The wood section shall be of sufficient length to fit compactly into one end of the aluminum tubing and for secure attachment (clinching, etc.) to the tubing. The threaded end shall have a metal ferrule attached for reinforcement. The dimensions of the fitted ferrule shall be not less than 1-1/16 inches outside diameter and 5/16 inch width and shall overlap the end by not less than 3/32 inch. The outside diameter of the wood immediately adjacent to the ferrule shall be 1-1/8 (+1/16) inches for a distance of not less than 11/16 inch and reduced sharply to slightly less than 1 inch diameter to fit into the tubing. The opposite end of the main body of the duster head adaptor shall have a securely attached frame for attachment of the duster head (3.4.2). The frame shall be formed as a looped assembly measuring approximately 8-1/4 inches long overall and 3-1/2 inches at the widest point. The frame shall be made of solid plastic rod or tubular plastic not less than 3/8 inch diameter.

3.4.1.3 Swivel adaptor. The swivel adaptor shall be made of aluminum or wood with one end having a threaded hole (suitably reinforced with metal ferrule if wood hole) of the standard Acme size to fit the threaded end of the innermost slider tube as specified in 3.2. The other (distal) end shall have a heavy duty 3/4 - 5 threads per inch Acme thread for a minimum of 1-1/16 inch for direct attachment of brushes, paint rollers, and similar items having a threaded hole or socket to fit. The swivel adaptor shall be so constructed that both horizontal and vertical surfaces can be cleaned, painted, etc. Locking device shall be provided to retain either the horizontal or vertical position of the swivel adaptor as well as intermediate positions in between.

3.4.2 Duster head. The duster head shall be made of rows of cotton yarn sewn to the outer surfaces of a pocket assembly made from cotton duck or canvas type backing cloth, with tie tapes. The pocket assembly shall be made by folding, stitching and/or seaming the cloth in such a manner that three sides are closed and one end is open for insertion of the frame specified in 3.4.1.2. Open end of pocket shall be hemmed all around and shall have the tape assembly attached to securely tie duster head to duster head adaptor (3.4.1.2). Pocket shall finish approximately 9-3/4 inches long and 6 inches wide. Rows of cotton yarns shall be sewn all around the outside of the pocket and when in a relaxed state shall completely cover the pocket or the outer surfaces. Free ends of yarns shall measure approximately 2-3/8 inches when held in extended position. The finished duster head shall measure approximately 11 inches long and 8 inches wide overall in a flat and relaxed state and shall weigh not less than 4 ounces.



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3.5 Workmanship. The extension handles and adaptors shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. Occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels. Telescoping and extending of the handle shall be an efficient and smooth operation. Locking device shall provide for firm locking of component sections. Metal shall be free from burrs and roughened spots.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, inspection shall be made of the completed end item for conformance with all provisions of this specification.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Inspection of components. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials are manufactured, tested and inspected to ensure conformance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3.2 Examination of the end item. The item shall be examined for defects in design, material, construction and workmanship as listed in table I. For sampling, the inspection level shall be level II and the acceptable quality level (AQL) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be 1.5. The lot for purposes of examination shall be all the extension handles and accessories, as applicable, offered for delivery to the Government at one time. The sample unit for this examination shall be one completely fabricated and finished extension handle and/or one each of each accessory, as applicable. The Government reserves the right to perform 100% inspection of submitted lots.

TABLE I

| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Extension handle Components and assembly | Any section or part missing and failure to meet specified type or size. |
| | Damaged or malformed. |
| | Any sharp burrs or metal sliver that may cause injury. |
| | Any part that will not operate or requires abnormal force to operate. |
| | Locking device does not function properly. |
| | Component parts missing, defective, damaged, or broken. |
| | Metal surfaces excessively spotted, stained or otherwise discolored. |
| | Threaded end not proper type or poorly constructed. |
| | Workmanship poor. |
| Plastic sleeve | Missing |
| | Handle shaft not completely covered as specified. |
| | Dirt or foreign matter imbedded in finish. |
| Adaptors | Not specified type. |
| | Damaged or malformed. |
| | Any sharp burrs or metal sliver that may cause injury. |
| | Any part that will not operate or requires abnormal force to operate. |
| | Threaded hole or threaded end, as applicable, not proper type or poorly constructed. |
| | Surfaces excessively spotted, stained, or otherwise discolored. |
| | Workmanship poor. |
| Duster head | Any section missing. |
| | Rancid or objectionable odor |
| | Insect infestation. |
| | Spotted, soiled, or stained. |
| | Tie tapes omitted. |
| | Free ends of yarns not evenly distributed around duster head. |
| | Construction of pocket not as specified. |
| | Any weakening material defect such as hole, tear, cut, smash or other defect which may develop into a hole or which affects serviceability. |



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4.3.3 Dimensional examination. The extension handle and/or accessories, as applicable, shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not in conformance with the requirements specified in 3.3 shall be classified as a major defect. Other dimensions not in conformance with the requirements specified herein shall be classified as a minor defect. The lot size and sample unit shall be as specified in 4.3.2. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL's expressed in defects per hundred unit shall be 1.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

4.3.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Markings (exterior and interior) | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application. |
| Materials | Any component missing, or damaged. |
| Workmanship | Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.<br>Distortion of container. |

4.4 Testing of the end item. The completed end item shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2. The lot size shall be the same as that specified in 4.3.2. The sample unit shall be one extension handle with or without adaptors as applicable. The Government reserves the right to perform 100% inspection of submitted lots.

4.4.1 Inspection for operational efficiency of extension handles. The extension handles shall be inspected for operational efficiency, including the telescoping, extending, balancing, locking of the unit and attachment of adaptors. The sample size for this examination and the acceptance number shall be as shown in table III.

TABLE III. Sample size.

| Lot size | Sample size | Acceptance Number |
|---|---|---|
| Up to 30 | 3 | 0 |
| 31 to 60 | 5 | 0 |
| 61 to 90 | 7 | 0 |
| 91 to 150 | 10 | 0 |
| 151 to 300 | 15 | 0 |
| 301 to 500 | 20 | 0 |
| 501 to 900 | 25 | 0 |
| 901 to 1,400 | 30 | 0 |
| 1,401 to 2,000 | 35 | 0 |
| 2,001 to 2,800 | 40 | 1 |
| 2,801 and up | 50 | 2 |

4.4.2 Inspection for hardness, high-low temperature and dielectric strength of plastic sleeve. The completed handles shall be selected for the following tests:

Hardness, plastic (4.5.1)
High-low temperature, plastic (4.5.2)
Dielectric strength, plastic (4.5.3)

Any evidence of failure shall be cause for rejection of the entire inspection lot.



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4.5 Test methods.

4.5.1 Hardness, plastic. A plastic sleeved aluminum handle shaft or any portion thereof required to make the test shall be subjected to the hardness test as described in method 3021 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601, using the type A Shore Durometer.

4.5.2 High-low temperature, plastic. A plastic sleeved aluminum handle shaft or any portion thereof required to make the test shall be subjected to a high-low temperature in a circulating air cabinet or oven as described in paragraph 4.6.5 of method 6011 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406.

4.5.3 Dielectric strength, plastic. A plastic sleeved aluminum handle shaft or any portion thereof required to make the test shall be subjected to 6,000 volts for 1 minute in accordance with the test described in paragraph 4.4.1 of method 4031 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406. Test shall be conducted at room temperature.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.1.1.1 Handles. The threads of each handle shall be protected with tape or a plastic thread protector. The handle extension sections shall be telescoped to the minimum length and secured with the locking mechanism. A quantity of handles as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.1.2 Duster head. Each duster head shall be packaged in a plastic bag, heat sealed. The duster heads in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W6c. The box shall be closed and waterproofed sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.1.3 Duster head adaptor. The duster head adaptor in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.1.4 Swivel adaptor. The swivel adaptor in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.1.5 Squeegee adaptor. The squeegee adaptor in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W5c. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.1.2 Unitized package. When specified (6.2), the handle, duster head and adaptors or any combination thereof shall be packaged together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, W6c. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.2.1.1 Handles. The threads of each handle shall be protected with tape or a plastic thread protector. The handle extension sections shall be telescoped to the minimum length and secured with the locking mechanism. A quantity of handles as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.



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5.1.2.1.2 Duster head. Each duster head shall be packaged in a plastic bag, heat sealed. The duster heads in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2.1.3 Duster head adaptor. The duster head adaptor in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2.1.4 Swivel adaptor. The swivel adaptor in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2.1.5 Squeegee adaptor. The squeegee adaptor in quantities as specified (6.2) shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2.2 Unitized package. When specified (6.2), the handle, duster head and adaptors or any combination thereof shall be packaged together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The handles, duster heads or adaptors shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of handles, duster heads or adaptors of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3, PPP-B-591, class II, PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2, PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. The gross weight of the triple wall box or the wood boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds. The gross weight of the PPP-B-636 box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. The unit packages shall not be overpacked.

5.2.3 Level C. The handles, duster heads or adaptors shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The extension handle is intended for use with brushes, paint rollers, etc., for cleaning, painting, washing and rinsing high surfaces where electrical contact presents no problem.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (1.2.1.2, 3.3 and 6.4).
(c) Style or styles of adaptor (s) when required (1.2.2 and 6.3).
(d) When duster head is required (1.2.3 and 6.3).
(e) When preproduction sample is required (3.1).



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(f) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Quantity of extension handles, adaptors and duster heads, as applicable, per package (5.1.1.1.1 thru 5.1.1.1.5 and 5.1.2.1.1 thru 5.1.2.1.5).
(h) When unitized package is required (5.1.1.2 and 5.1.2.2).

6.3 Extension handles may be procured with or without accessories. For the guidance of procurement officers, the following information is submitted:

6.3.1 Extension handle. The extension handle has as an integral part of the unit a threaded end as specified in 3.2. Brushes, paint rollers and similar items with a threaded hole or threaded socket to match can be attached directly to the end of the handle without the use of adaptors. Therefore, extension handles may be procured without adaptors for these uses.

6.3.2 Squeegee adaptors. Squeegee adaptors should be procured when squeegees with tapered handle socket are to be used with the extension handle. Squeegee adaptor can be attached directly to extension handle. Squeegee adaptor is constructed (tapered) to fit handle socket of squeegee.

6.3.3 Duster head adaptor. Duster head adaptors should be procured when the duster head specified herein is required for dusting operations. Duster head adaptor can be attached directly to extension handle.

6.3.4 Swivel adaptor. Swivel adaptors should be procured when an adjustable unit is required to clean, paint, etc., both horizontal and vertical surfaces with brushes, paint rollers, etc., that have a threaded hole or threaded socket to fit. Swivel adaptor can be attached directly to extension handle.

6.3.5 Duster head. Duster head is a special type construction and requires use of duster head adaptor for use with extension handle.

6.4 Sizes. For the guidance of procurement officers, some of the sizes which are commercially available are 3-6 feet, 4-8 feet and 5-10 feet. Sizes longer than 10 feet when fully extended may be procured for specific applications only upon approval of safety officers.



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